

DIPLOMA IN EDUCATION PROGRAMME
SCHOOL OF EDUCATION
THE UNIVERSITY OF THE WEST INDIES, ST. AUGUSTINE

MUSIC

LESSON PLAN: Lesson 1 in Unit plan

TEACHERS: Ms. Samantha Joseph (Music) and Ms. Marcela Boatswain (History/Social Studies) – co-teaching
SCHOOL: St. Joseph's Convent San Fernando **DATE:** 30th September 2026
CLASS/FORM: Form 4 **No. in class:** 3 **TIME:** 10:25 am **No. of period(s):** 2 **Duration:** 70 mins

Planning for the lesson

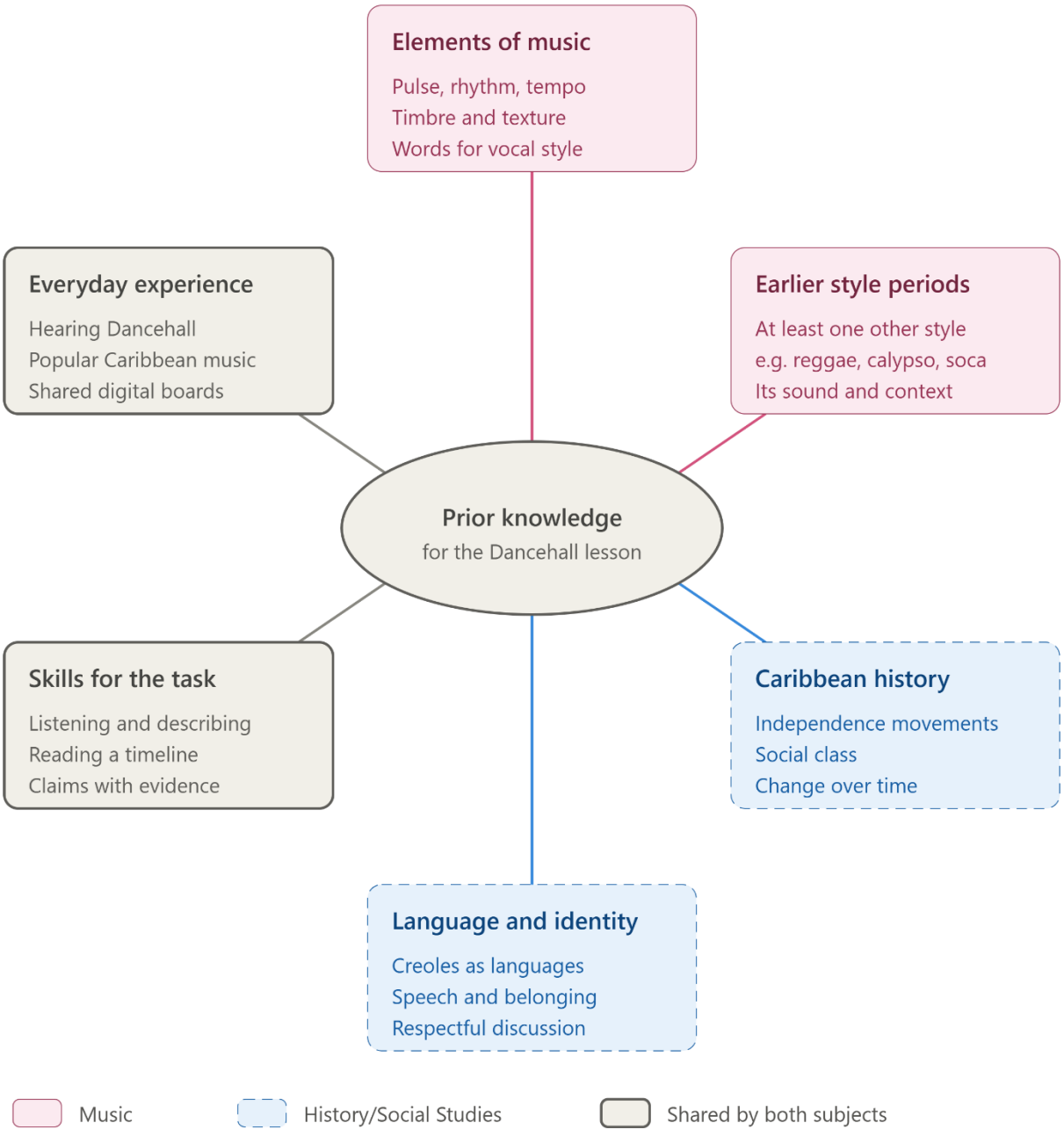
UNIT PLAN: Music History – Caribbean style periods, Dancehall.

TOPIC: Dancehall as a reflection of Caribbean society: stylistic elements of performance and the historical, economic and socio-cultural contexts that shaped them.

INTEGRATION MODEL: Interdisciplinary (Drake & Burns, 2004). Music and History/Social Studies keep their own standards but are organised around a **shared concept** (music reflects and shapes the society that produces it; change, identity and social commentary) and **shared skills** (analysing a source, justifying claims with evidence, linking context to content).

ESSENTIAL QUESTION: *How does the sound of Dancehall reflect the society that created it?*

CONCEPT map / graphic organizer of knowledge required for lesson or Unit:



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What we HEAR (Music: musical feature)	Link	WHY (History/Social Studies: context)
Riddim: instrumental tracks reused by many artists	reuse and "versioning"	Sound system culture; small, low-cost producers and selectors serving inner-city communities
Digital/synthesised production (e.g., "Sleng Teng")	cheap technology	Economic constraints; new affordable keyboards and drum machines in the 1980s
DJ/toasting vocal delivery over the riddim	live crowd interaction	Sound system DJs as community voices; oral tradition; social commentary
Jamaican Creole in lyrics	identity and authenticity	Post-independence national identity; language, class and respectability
Lyrical themes ("slackness" and "culture")	contested values	Urban poverty, political tension in the 1970s–80s, class attitudes to popular culture

CURRICULUM INTEGRATION AREAS across subjects and materials needed:

- **History/Social Studies (Theme 9: Caribbean Society):** post-independence Jamaica, class, identity, popular culture and social change.
- **Language Arts:** Jamaican Creole as a language of identity; reading and interpreting lyrics; writing an evidence-based claim.
- **ICT:** shared digital board (e.g., Padlet or Microsoft Whiteboard), tap-tempo tool, digital exit ticket; optional free browser tool for recreating a riddim (e.g., Chrome Music Lab or BandLab).
- **Mathematics:** pulse, tempo (beats per minute) and rhythmic subdivision when measuring and comparing tempo.

Materials: speakers and audio clips (radio/clean edits previewed in advance); projector or screen; tablets/phones/laptop; headphones; chart paper (wall chart); coloured sticky notes (three colours); markers and string/arrows; printed timeline event cards; Listening Guide; Integrated Song Analysis Organizer; Exit Ticket; dual-discipline rubric.

The lesson plan:

PRE-KNOWLEDGE required (what knowledge/experiences do students bring to this lesson?)

- Basic elements of music: pulse, rhythm, tempo, timbre, texture, and the vocabulary for describing vocal style.
- Prior study of at least one other Caribbean style period (e.g., reggae, calypso/soca) in the Music History unit.
- From History/Social Studies: Caribbean independence movements and the idea of social class.
- Everyday familiarity with popular Caribbean music, and experience using shared digital tools.

Strategies

- **Interdisciplinary co-teaching:** both teachers present throughout; the Music teacher (MT) leads the musical lens and the History teacher (HT) leads the historical lens, then they co-facilitate the integrated task, discussion and assessment.
- **Inquiry** driven by the essential question; **collaborative cause-and-effect chart** (physical and digital) as the shared thinking tool.

- **Multimodal (visual, auditory, kinaesthetic) learning** with technology integrated (see coverage table below); **think-pair-share** and a structured "take a stand" discussion.
- **Differentiation:** sentence starters for claims, a glossary (riddim, toasting, sound system, Creole), and choice of how findings are presented.
- **Content note:** only radio/clean edits are used and all clips are previewed in advance; sensitive lyrical content is discussed analytically with agreed discussion norms (HFLE link).

Learner type	How the lesson addresses it	Where
Visual	Collaborative wall chart with colour-coded sticky notes and arrows; interactive timeline; annotated Listening Guide; projected images of sound system culture	Induction, Sections 1–3
Auditory	Repeated close listening with headphones; call-and-response; teacher and peer discussion; students record a 60-second "DJ commentary" voice note; take-a-stand debate	Induction, Sections 1, 3, 4
Kinaesthetic	Stomping/clapping the one-drop and digital riddim patterns; physically sequencing timeline cards; placing and linking notes on the wall chart with string; moving along the "take a stand" line	Sections 1, 2, 4
Technology	Shared digital board mirroring the chart; tap-tempo tool to measure BPM; optional free browser tool to recreate a riddim; digital exit ticket. *Low-tech fallback: paper chart, phone stopwatch, printed exit ticket.*	Sections 1, 3, Final evaluation

Goals

To develop students' understanding of the stylistic elements of Dancehall performance and to build appreciation of the historical, economic and socio-cultural contexts in which the music originated, was created and performed.

At the end of this lesson, pupils will be able to (the related standards as indicated in the curriculum, inclusive of HFLE):

- **CSEC Music (Music History):** understand the stylistic elements of performance of selected style periods; appreciate the historical, economic and socio-cultural contexts of their origin and performance.
- **History/Social Studies (Theme 9: Caribbean Society):** Explain how social and economic conditions in 1970s-80s Jamaica shaped cultural expression and evaluate how popular culture reflects class, identity and social tensions in Caribbean society.

Objectives of the lesson	Classification of objectives	Domain
1. Identify and describe at least three stylistic elements of Dancehall performance (riddim, tempo, DJ/toasting style, Jamaican Creole, digital production).	Knowledge / Comprehension	Cognitive
2. Explain how at least three of these elements link to the social, economic or political conditions of 1970s–80s Jamaica.	Analysis	Cognitive
3. Reproduce the rhythmic feel of a one-drop riddim and a digital riddim using body percussion (or a digital tool) and describe how they differ.	Application (imitation/manipulation)	Psychomotor
4. Respond respectfully to differing views on "slackness" and "culture" and demonstrate appreciation of Dancehall as a cultural expression worth studying.	Valuing / Responding	Affective
5. Construct an evidence-based claim answering the essential question that uses one piece of musical evidence and one piece of historical evidence.	Evaluation / Creation	Cognitive

(Objectives include at least one for each domain.)

SET INDUCTION (*strategy to draw learners into the lesson*) – Time allotted: **10 minutes (0–10)**

Teaching Strategy	Student Activity	Resources
Mystery listening (MT and HT together). Play 60–90 seconds of "Bam Bam" with no context. Display one or two images of a sound system session (licensed or Creative Commons). Introduce the **collaborative chart**: pink notes = what we hear; green notes = what it might say about the people/society; blue notes (HT) = historical facts. Pose the essential question.	**[A]** Listen with eyes closed on the first play. **[K]** Tap or clap the pulse on the second play. **[V]** Write one musical observation and one social inference on separate sticky notes and place them on the wall chart; type the same on the shared digital board **[T]**. Share one note aloud (think-pair-share).	"Bam Bam" audio clip (Sister Nancy) Speakers; projector Wall chart; coloured sticky notes; markers Shared digital board (e.g., Padlet)

SECTION 1 – Musical lens (led by the Music teacher) – Time allotted: 12 minutes (10–22)

Teaching points:

- Dancehall emerged in Jamaica in the late 1970s and 1980s from roots reggae and sound system culture.
- **Riddim:** reusable instrumental track; the same riddim is voiced by many artists. **One-drop** feel versus the sparse, programmed feel of digital riddims.
- **Vocal style:** DJ/toasting (rhythmic speech-singing over the riddim) versus singing; use of Jamaican Creole.
- **Production shift:** from live bands to affordable digital keyboards and drum machines (e.g., "Under Mi Sleng Teng", 1985).

METHOD

Teaching Strategy	Student Activity	Resources
Guided listening (MT): play short excerpts of "Bam Bam" (1982) and "Under Mi Sleng Teng" (1985); model identifying riddim, tempo, vocal delivery and language using the Listening Guide. **Call-and-response body percussion** (MT): teach the one-drop feel (stomp/clap emphasis on beat 3) then a steadier digital riddim pattern. **Tempo check** (MT): students tap tempo to measure beats per minute for each song.	**[A]** Listen with headphones and complete Part A of the Listening Guide. **[K]** Echo and perform both patterns; swap patterns in pairs. **[T]** Measure BPM with a tap-tempo tool and record on the shared board. **[V]** Write each feature on a pink "What we HEAR" note, place it on the chart and add a "Why?" question mark beside it.	Audio clips (two songs) Headphones; speakers Listening Guide (Part A) Tap-tempo website/app Wall chart; pink sticky notes; shared digital board

SECTIONAL REVIEW and feedback (formative assessment strategies) – Time allotted: 3 minutes

Quick check: each student names one feature and states one "Why?" question for the History lens. MT observes the body-percussion patterns (Objective 3) and notes accuracy on the checklist.

SECTION 2 – Historical and social lens (led by the History/Social Studies teacher) – Time allotted: 14 minutes (22–36)

Teaching points:

- Post-independence Jamaica (independence in 1962): social and economic pressures, unemployment and urban poverty in Kingston communities.
- Political tension and violence in the 1970s and economic difficulty shaping the lives of young people in inner-city communities.
- Sound systems as community entertainment and a platform for DJs as social commentators; cheaper digital technology in the 1980s.
- Class attitudes to popular culture: respectability versus "slackness"; language and identity (Jamaican Creole). Link to Theme 9 concepts of class, identity and culture.

METHOD

Teaching Strategy	Student Activity	Resources
Context briefing (HT) using a visual timeline of 1960s–1980s events with a map of Kingston. **Timeline sequencing activity** (HT): distribute event cards for students to place in order. **Linking** (MT and HT): guide students to answer each "Why?" by connecting pink "What we HEAR" notes to blue "WHY" cards with string or arrows.	**[V]** Watch the timeline and annotate it. **[K]** Physically sequence the event cards on the wall or floor timeline. **[A]** Listen to the HT briefing and ask or answer "Why?" questions. **[K][V]** Connect each musical feature to a historical cause with string or arrows; add blue notes. **[T]** Mirror at least two links on the shared digital board.	Timeline slides/projector; map of Jamaica Printed event cards (blue) Wall chart; blue sticky notes; string/markers Shared digital board

SECTIONAL REVIEW and feedback (formative assessment strategies) – Time allotted: 3 minutes
Questioning by HT: "Which cause best explains this feature, and what evidence shows it?" Check that each student has at least two correct feature-to-context links on the chart (Objective 2).

SECTION 3 – Integrated task – "Dancehall Detectives" (both teachers) – Time allotted: 18 minutes (36–54)

Teaching points:

- Applying both lenses to one song: feature + evidence + context + link.
- Skills shared by both subjects: using evidence to justify a claim and presenting findings clearly.
- Students show understanding in different ways (voice note, annotated map, or riddim recreation).

METHOD

Teaching Strategy	Student Activity	Resources
Assign songs: each student analyses one excerpt: "Bam Bam" (1982), "Under Mi Sleng Teng" (1985), or a third pre-approved song. **Task:** complete the Integrated Song Analysis Organizer (feature, evidence, context, link). **Choice of product** (one per student): (a) a 60-second "DJ commentary" voice note; (b) an annotated visual listening map; (c) a recreated riddim pattern (body percussion or free digital tool) with explanation. **Circulate and give discipline-specific feedback:** MT on musical evidence; HT on historical evidence. **Claim writing:** model one sentence starter.	**[A][V]** Listen with headphones, annotate and complete the organizer. **[A][T]** or **[V]** or **[K][T]** Produce the chosen product. **[V]** Add final cause-and-effect notes to the wall chart and shared board. Write a 2–3 sentence **claim** answering the essential question with one musical and one historical piece of evidence (Objective 5). Share findings in 2 minutes each.	Integrated Song Analysis Organizer Audio clips; headphones Tablets/phones for voice notes or free browser tool (Chrome Music Lab/BandLab) Sentence starters and glossary Dual-discipline rubric

SECTIONAL REVIEW and feedback (formative assessment strategies) – Time allotted: 4 minutes
Peer feedback during sharing using "two stars and a wish" (one musical, one historical). Teachers record organizer completion against the rubric (Objectives 1, 2 and 5).

SECTION 4 – Discussion – "Slackness vs. Culture": take a stand (both teachers) – Time allotted: 10 minutes (54–64)

Teaching points:

- Dancehall has been praised as authentic social commentary and criticised as vulgar or violent ("slackness" versus "culture"). Both views are explored with evidence.
- Agreed norms: respect every view, critique ideas not people, support opinions with musical and historical evidence. HFLE link: respectful discussion of sensitive content.

METHOD

Teaching Strategy	Student Activity	Resources
Take a stand line (both): teachers read statements, e.g., "Dancehall reflects real conditions in society"; "Dancehall harms society's values"; "Dancehall deserves a place in school music study." MT prompts: "What in the music supports your view?" HT prompts: "What in the history supports it?" Invite students to change position after hearing others.	**[K]** Move to a point on the agree–disagree line. **[A]** Explain the position aloud using one musical and one historical piece of evidence from the chart. **[K][A]** Move again if persuaded and say why (Objective 4).	Floor line (tape) with "Agree" and "Disagree" signs Statement cards Wall chart as evidence bank Discussion norms poster

SECTIONAL REVIEW and feedback (formative assessment strategies) – Time allotted: 2 minutes

Teachers note the quality of reasoning and respect shown on the observation checklist (Objective 4). Brief teacher summary of strongest arguments.

CLOSURE (How will you end the lesson?) – Time allotted: **3 minutes (64–67)**

Read back the completed collaborative chart together: each student adds one final sentence beginning "Dancehall is …". Photograph the chart and share the digital board link with students (also kept as evidence of the integrated learning). Teachers connect the day's findings to the CSEC Music appraising skills and to Theme 9.

FINAL EVALUATION – Time allotted: **3 minutes (67–70)**

Exit ticket (digital form or paper): "Dancehall reflects Jamaican society because …… (music evidence) and …… (history evidence)." Marked by both teachers using the dual-discipline rubric.

Reasonable level of achievement: all three students score at least 10/14 (about 70%) across the lesson tasks, and at least two of three reach "Proficient" on the integration criterion of the rubric.

Related objective(s) to be tested and accompanying Table of Specification:

Objective	Level	Assessment item	Marks
1	Knowledge/Comprehension	Organizer Part A: three features named and described	3
2	Analysis	Organizer Part B: three feature-to-context links with evidence	3
3	Application (psychomotor)	Observation checklist: both riddim patterns performed accurately	2
4	Valuing (affective)	Observation checklist: respectful, evidence-based participation in the discussion	2
5	Evaluation/Creation	Exit ticket: claim, musical evidence, historical evidence, linking "because"	4
		Total	**14**

FOLLOW-UP ACTIVITIES/LESSON: Students choose one contemporary Caribbean song and apply the cause-and-effect chart to it (individual work). Next lesson: compare Dancehall with another style period studied (e.g., calypso/soca) using the same chart. The History teacher extends the topic within Theme 9.